

Nishant Dougall

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Harm Reduction Peer Support | Community Services

Community services and project management professional with lived experience navigating the complexities faced by people who use drugs. Brings 4+ years of experience in the sector, including 1 year as a Harm Reduction Peer Worker, and 10 years of experience in project management. Offering excellent communication and interpersonal skills, enabling effective collaboration with diverse stakeholders. A classic Capricorn – hardworking, rational, and an excellent problem-solver. Eager to leverage skills and experience to promote the health and wellbeing of people who use drugs and advocating for an end to the war on drugs.

EXPERIENCE

headspace National • Naarm

03/2024 – 10/2024

Multicultural Practice Team Internship

- Completed internship on the diversity and inclusion team responsible for culturally responsive practice across the headspace network of approx 150 sites nationally.
- Managed the International Students Experience Project, facilitating six focus groups with over 36 international students to identify support needs.
- Developed and drafted culturally appropriate, culturally sensitive resources for national delivery.

Multicultural Practice Project Intern

- Led International Students Project centre on community involvement and capacity building, participating in research process by leading co-design focus groups with thirty-six students from diverse backgrounds to ensure adequate data collection.
- Output of consultation, collaboration and co-design was culturally appropriate resources enhancing community education via creation of culturally sensitive mental health resources.
- Developed web content based on headspace ethos and methodology, considered best practice.
- Developed national service delivery improvements, set for rollout in Q4 2025.

Diamond Valley Community Support • Naarm, Australia

03/2022 – 03/2024

Community Support Worker

- Provided comprehensive service delivery to individuals in crisis, including emergency relief, material aid, and advocacy, with a focus on person-centred and strengths-based practice.
- Conducted over 400 client interviews to assess needs, develop tailored support plans, and advocacy for individuals facing complex challenges, including those impacted by criminalization.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Business in Marketing

Qld University of Technology
Meanjin

Master of Finance

Monash University
Melbourne

Diploma of Community Services

Melbourne Polytechnic
Naarm, Australia

SKILLS

- Adaptability
- Advocacy
- Asana
- Autonomous Work
- Business Analysis
- Client Care & Support
- Client-centered approach
- Client record management
- Collaboration
- Communication
- Communication Skills
- Community-based work
- Community Engagement
- Community participation principles
- Community Resources Navigation
- Community Services
- Confidentiality
- Conflict resolution
- Continuous Improvement

- Delivered empathetic and compassionate support, utilizing de-escalation techniques to ensure client well-being.

Thorne Harbour Health

12/2018 – 11/2020

Harm Reduction Peer Worker

SMART Recovery Facilitator

- Facilitated peer support fortnightly meetings regarding AOD issues, using lived experience to help clients learn skills and strategies using harm reduction framework.

Harm Reduction Peer Worker

- Led biweekly peer support meetings using harm reduction framework, coaching clients on AOD issues.
- Cultivated a safe environment for recovery, addressing relapse prevention and holistic health.
- Guided clients in enhancing mental health and mindfulness, contributing to overall well-being.

Rainbow Connection Delivery Volunteer

- Delivered over two thousand care packages to vulnerable immunocompromised clients as part of outreach initiatives during COVID-19.
- Coordinated client interactions, ensuring timely material and psychosocial support for vulnerable individuals.
- Implemented stringent safety protocols for contactless deliveries.

Sex On Premise Venue Outreach Volunteer

- Provided support to clients at sex-on-premise venues for their health and well-being
- Answered questions about sexual health, HIV, mental health, and substance use
- Suggested appropriate internal and external referrals

Sex-on-premises Venue (SOPV) Outreach

- Provided sexual health and HIV support to over 100 clients at Sex-on-Premises Venues (SOPVs).
- Built rapport and trust with people who use drugs regularly in a high-pressure setting.

Sex-on-premises Venue Outreach

- Provided support to over 100 clients at sex-on-premises venues, answering questions about sexual and mental health and providing appropriate information and resources.

Sexual Health Outreach Support Worker

- Provided sexual health and HIV support to clients at Sex-on-Premises Venues offering harm reduction resources and education to promote safe sexual practices.

Coutts & Co • Covent Garden, London

02/2018 – 09/2018

Project Manager – Regulatory Compliance

- Ensured timely completion of multiple projects concurrently within Royal Bank of Scotland's private banking division, with high-net worth clients with liquifiable assets over £5M.
- Leveraged effective communication skills to present findings of the project to diverse audiences, ensuring bank complied with new regulatory requirements introduced by government to increase consumer protections and rights.

- Crisis Intervention
- Crisis Management
- Data Analysis
- Data collection
- Documentation
- Documentation Management
- Drafting Reports
- Ethical boundaries
- First Aid
- Flexibility
- Harm Minimisation
- Harm Reduction
- Harm reduction framework
- Harm Reduction Peer Work
- Healthcare
- HIV/STI Knowledge
- Homelessness Issues
- Initial Assessments
- Interpersonal & Communication
- LGBTQIA+ Intersectionality
- LGBTQIA support
- Lived Experience
- Mental Health First Aid
- Mental Health Support
- Microsoft Office Suite
- Neurodiversity
- Organisational Skills
- Outreach
- Peer support
- Person-Led Support
- Policy Development
- Priority setting
- Problem-Solving
- Project Delivery
- Project Management
- Project Planning
- Public health
- Record Keeping
- Reflective Practice
- Regulatory Compliance

Independent Television News (ITN) • London**02/2018 – 09/2018****Business Analyst**

- Led analysis on a tech project in ITN's Finance department, contributing to process improvement.
- Responsible for creating and managing staff training and project communications, showcasing communication and training skills.

Royal Bank of Scotland (RBS) • Bishopsgate, London**01/2016 – 09/2018****Project Manager – Policy Development**

- Led the RBS Corporate Banking workstream of ethics project centred regarding high-net value clients engaging in aggressive tax avoidance strategies.
- Collaborated with Legal and Compliance teams to streamline bank processes and strengthen tax avoidance identification protocols across divisions.

National Australia Bank (NAB) • Naarm, Australia**01/2009 – 01/2014****Project Analyst**

- Identified and documented requirements for a new centralised process on largescale program development.
- Designed the solution, drafted appropriate documents, and maintained records per NAB's policies and procedures regarding project delivery.

Graduate Program

- Supported manager in managing a portfolio of 100 small business clients
- Clients in Carlton with around \$2 million in borrowings

CERTIFICATIONS**Alcohol and Other Drug Skill Set**

Odyssey Institute

02/2025 – 10/2025

Mental Health First Aid**Victorian Driver's Licence**

VicRoads

Victorian Drivers Licence**Working With Children Check****First Aid**

St John Ambulance Australia

SMART Recovery Peer Facilitator

SMART Recovery Australia

Alcohol and Other Drug (AOD) Skillset

Odyssey House Institute

SMART Recovery Harm Reduction Peer Facilitator

- Relationship Building
- Requirements Analysis
- Resource development
- Risk Assessment
- Sexual Health Support
- SMART Recovery Facilitator
- Solution Design
- Stakeholder Collaboration
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Strengths-based practice
- Time management
- Training and Facilitation
- Training Delivery
- Training Packages Development
- Trauma-informed support
- Understanding of intersectionality
- Verbal Communication
- Working With Children Check

Lived Experience

- AOD Issues
- Intersectionality
- LGBTQIA+ Health & Wellbeing Issues
- Psychosocial Disability
- Racism
- TGD Drivers of Criminalisation & Incarceration
- TGD Health & Wellbeing Issues

Communication & People Skills

- Active listening
- Cultural Humility
- Cultural Sensitivity

- Empathy
- Interpersonal Skills
- Rapport Building
- Respectful Communication
- Written Communication